10. Alexander the great was eagerly awaiting the arrival of his mother while he was on his deathbed fearing that he may not live to see her he said take my entire kingdom oh god i wish i knew beforehand that my entire strength of men and material cant be exchanged for a single breath of life for then i wouldnt have wasted my life in amassing this empire

SPELLING

What is spelling?

Spelling is the art of assembling letters in the right order to form words. This is one of the most essential components of successful writing. Spelling aids in pronouncing words properly and reading perfectly. Learning to spell helps to cement (fuse/link)the connection (correlation) between letters and their sounds.

Spelling in English is tricky. It is because there are twenty six letters in the English alphabet, but there are about forty-four basic sounds. Moreover, the letters often do not match with the sounds. We should never hesitate to refer a dictionary, whenever there is confusion or doubt related to spelling.

Here are a few simple ways to improve our spelling skills:

- ❖ playing word games like scrabble and trying to solve crossword puzzles
- ❖ splitting long words into short chunks
- ❖ learning syllabification of words
- ❖ making a list of tricky words and memorizing them
- ❖ knowing the rules of spelling

There are certain spelling rules in English. If we observe those rules, we will be able to avoid spelling mistakes while writing. Let's have a quick recap of some spelling rules that you have already learnt in your earlier classes.

1. Final 'e'

a) When a suffix is added to words ending in silent 'e', the letter 'e' is normally dropped before a vowel.

e.g. drape + ed – draped / hope + ed – hoped / close + ed - closed strike + ing – striking / like + ing – liking / fine + er – finer / wise + \ er – wiser / large + er - larger brave + est – bravest / safe +est – safest / nice + est - nicest / love + able – lovable / move + able – movable

b) The final 'e' is not normally dropped before a consonant.

e.g. hope + full – hopeful / shame + full - shameful like + ness – likeness / tire + some – tiresome / use + less - useless / move + ment – movement / sure + ly – surely / nine + ty - ninety

c) Exceptions to the rule

e.g. true + ly – truly / due + ly - duly / awe + ful – awful / nine + th –

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